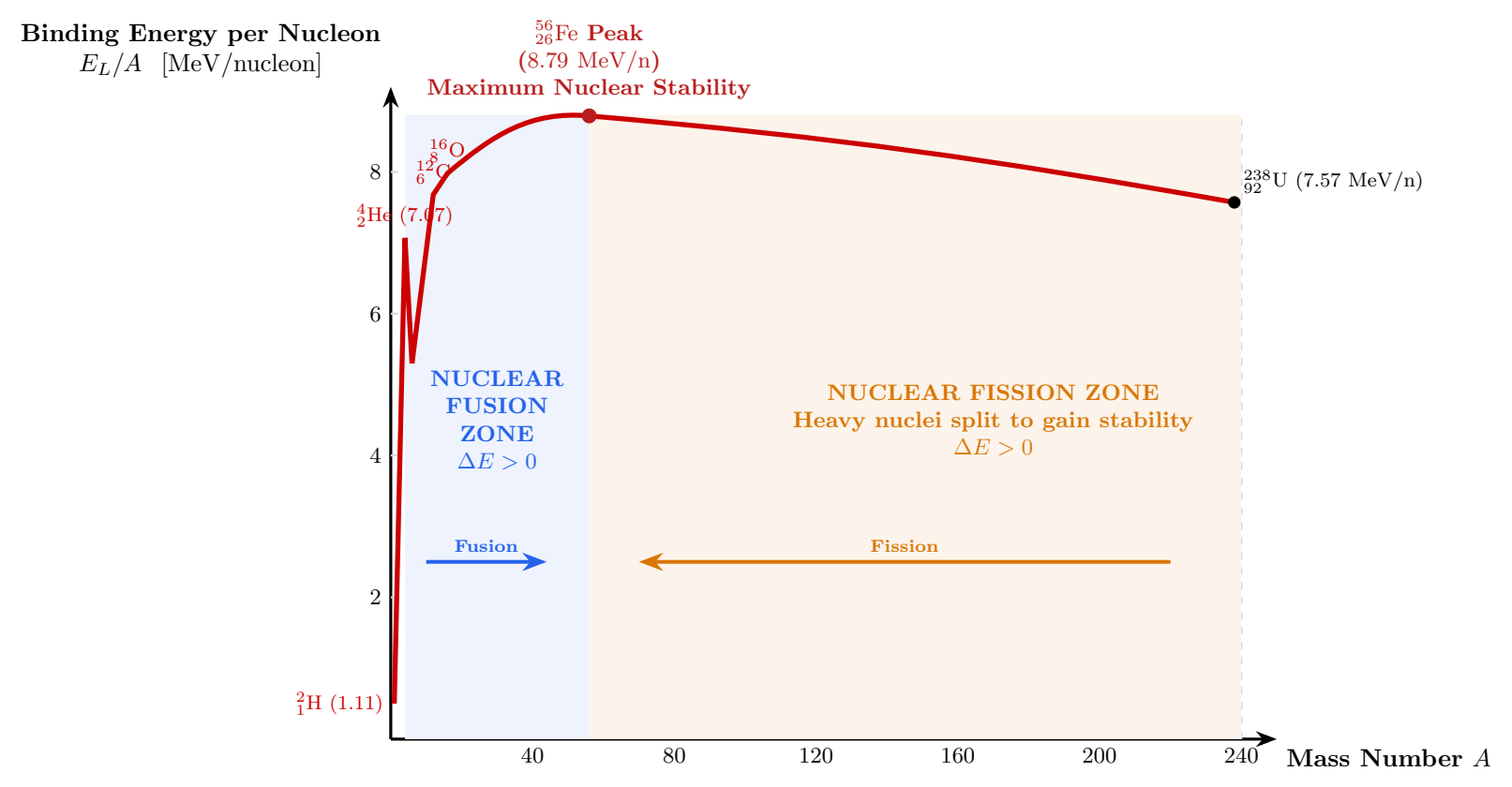

Binding Energy per Nucleon
E_L/A [MeV/nucleon]
$^{56}_{26}$Fe Peak
(8.79 MeV/n)
Maximum Nuclear Stability
$^{16}_{8}$O
$^{12}_{6}$C
$^{4}_{2}$He (7.07)
$^{238}_{92}$U (7.57 MeV/n)
NUCLEAR FUSION ZONE
$\Delta E > 0$
NUCLEAR FISSION ZONE
Heavy nuclei split to gain stability
$\Delta E > 0$
Fusion
Fission
$^{2}_{1}$H (1.11)
8
6
4
2
40
80
120
160
200
240
Mass Number A